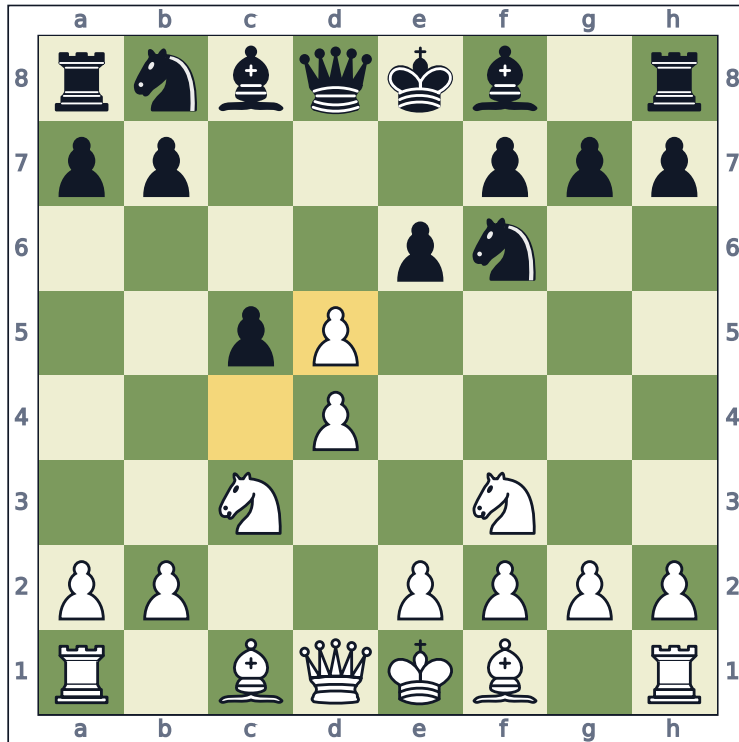


QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

Queen's Gambit Declined

ECO D41 | 10 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.22 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D41 covers Queen's Gambit Declined. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5 5. cxd5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

BLACK'S GOALS

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines. a gambit is a tactical contract: the sacrificed material must buy concrete time, lines, or targets.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. White is ahead by about 1 pawn unit. Central markers: Black pawn on c5, White pawn on d4, White pawn on d5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named D41 line

This section preserves all 10 names and defining routes assigned to D41 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5 5. cxd5

002 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense

1. c4 c5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. g3 d5 5. d4 e6

003 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. g3

004 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. g3 Nc6 7. Bg2

005 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, Endgame Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5 5. cxd5 cxd4 6. Qxd4 exd5 7. e4 dxe4 8. Qxd8+

006 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, Exchange Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. e4

007 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, Exchange Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. e4 Nxc3 7. bxc3

008 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, Knoch Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Nf3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. e4 Nxc3 7. bxc3 cxd4 8. cxd4 Bb4+ 9. Bd2 Bxd2+ 10. Qxd2 O-O 11. Bb5

009 Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, Pillsbury Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. Nc3 c5 5. cxd5 Nxd5 6. e3

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010

Queen's Gambit Declined: Semi-Tarrasch Defense, San Sebastian Variation

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. e4 Nxc3 6. bxc3 c5 7. Nf3 cxd4 8. cxd4 Bb4+ 9. Bd2 Qa5